Conversion of Fibrinogen

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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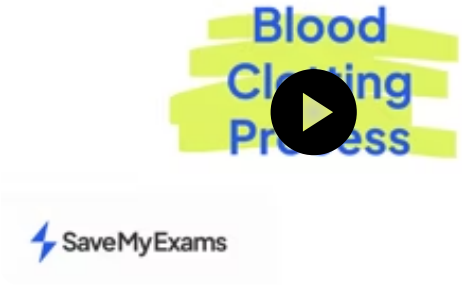

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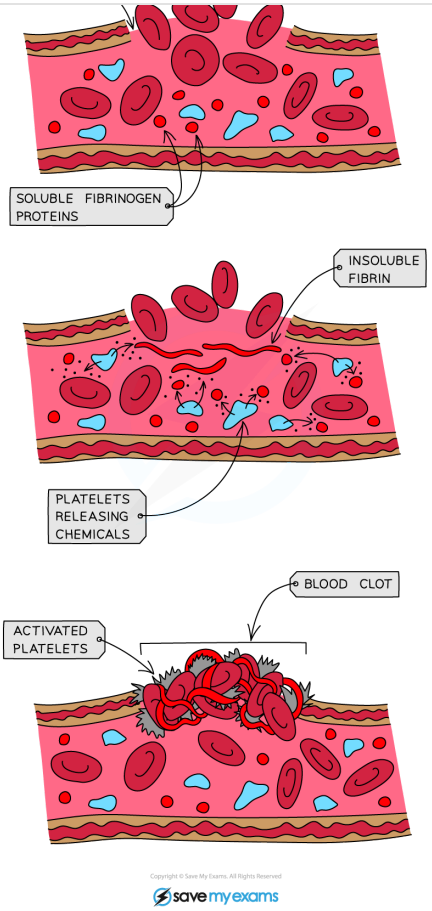
Conversion of Fibrinogen: Extended

Extended Tier Only

- Platelets are **fragments of cells which are involved in blood clotting** and forming scabs where the skin has been cut or punctured
- Blood clotting **prevents continued / significant blood loss** from wounds
- Scab formation seals the wound with an insoluble patch that **prevents entry of microorganisms** that could cause infection
- It remains in place until new skin has grown underneath it, sealing the skin again

Help me understand

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it



How the blood clots

- When the skin is broken (i.e. there is a wound) platelets arrive to stop the bleeding
- A series of reactions occur within the blood plasma
- Platelets release chemicals that cause **soluble fibrinogen proteins** to convert into **insoluble fibrin** and form an **insoluble mesh** across the wound, trapping red blood cells and therefore **forming a clot**
- The clot eventually dries and develops into a **scab** to protect the wound from bacteria entering

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